

Chapter 3

Millionaire Myth: The Wealthy Take Big Risks with Their Money

“A popsicle? You want to invest that much money into a popsicle?”

In my many years as a wealth coach, I’ve been honored to sit with hundreds of millionaires. Most of them, as we’re seeing in this book, are smart, hardworking, unassuming people. They built their wealth low and slow, managing risk and maximizing their rewards. Occasionally, though, I meet someone with a crazy scheme that they just *know* will double their money. No matter how hard I try, sometimes I just can’t talk these wide-eyed dreamers out of it.

I remember one guy in particular. He is a well-known hockey player on one of the NHL teams up north. He’d been on a hot streak for a while, and his salary had grown to more than he ever expected to make. Now, at that point in my career, I thought I had heard it all—but this guy proved me wrong. We had talked about some smart investments over the past year and he had seen his wealth begin to take off, but one day he came into my office with an “investment opportunity” I’d never heard of: popsicles.

“Chris, listen to this,” he said as we got started with the session. “A friend brought me an investment opportunity that sounds like a gold mine. We’re funding a company that’s going to make—get ready for this—*cough-syrup popsicles*! Doesn’t that sound great? Kids hate cough medicine, but they love popsicles. This is going to make a killing!”